

Figure 9: VM-creation9

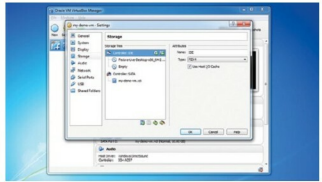


Figure 11: VM-creation12

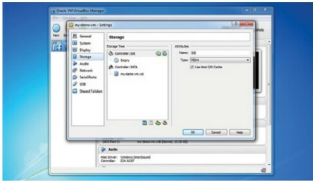


Figure 10: VM-creation10

- c. On the next window, from among all the options on the left hand side, click on **Storage**.
 - d. On the right hand side (see Figure 10), you will see a storage tree detailing storage controllers and devices attached to the VM.
 - e. On the same window, the first in the tree is the **Controller IDE**, for which the device list is empty; this means there is no DVD attached to the VM yet.
 - f. Select **Controller IDE** and click on the first 'plus' icon, which should say **Add CD/DVD Device** when you scroll the mouse over it.
 - g. The next window will show a box, which asks if you want to add a DVD disk. Click on **Choose disk**, browse to the DVD image location and select the image as desired. The selected DVD image should show up on the storage tab under **Controller IDE** (Figure 11).
 - h. Finally, go to the **System** tab in the **Settings** menu and arrange the boot order accordingly.
 - i. Now, in the **Settings** window, click **OK** to save all the changes. Once all the changes are saved, you will be brought back to the VirtualBox main page.
3. And yes, we are done... Now just click the **Start** button in the VirtualBox main page and start the VM.
 4. From here on, the VM will boot into the selected boot device, and you can continue installing the OS and then boot into it.

Advanced features of VirtualBox

Now that we have looked at the basics of VirtualBox, let's look at a few advanced features. Most of these features are useful for professional users and those who manage multiple VMs across many hosts. Since it's not possible to introduce all the features that VirtualBox offers, I will try to list a few.

1. **Manageability:** VBoxManage is a command line interface to VirtualBox, and it allows you to do much more than what can be done from a GUI. More details of how to use it can be found at <https://www.virtualbox.org/manual/ch08.html>.
 2. **VM groups:** The VirtualBox manager enables you to configure a group of VMs in order to manage and configure them collectively. More details are available at <https://www.virtualbox.org/manual/ch01.html#gui-vmggroups>
 3. **Create snapshots:** If you are familiar with virtualisation technology, you will know what a snapshot means. VirtualBox enables you to create snapshots of the VMs and restore them back to the previous state. More details are available at <https://www.virtualbox.org/manual/ch01.html#snapshots>
 4. **Creating a clone:** VirtualBox enables you to create the exact copy of an installed VM. This property is called cloning of a VM. More details are available at <https://www.virtualbox.org/manual/ch01.html#clone>
- VirtualBox is one of the best VM managers available even when compared with proprietary solutions. It offers a lot more than what desktop users may require and allows users to experience a smooth multi-OS environment. **END** 

References

- [1] <https://www.virtualbox.org>
- [2] <https://www.virtualbox.org/manual/UserManual.html>
- [3] <http://www.pcmag.com/encyclopedia/term/53961/virtualization>
- [4] <http://www.webopedia.com/TERM/V/virtualization.html>
- [5] <http://www.google.com>

By: Ashish Bunkar

The author has over five years' experience as a Linux professional. He likes sharing his interests in SAN and virtualisation technologies.